House of Representatives

General Assembly

File No. 551

February Session, 2026

Substitute House Bill No. 5546

House of Representatives, April 9, 2026

The Committee on Government Administration and Elections reported through REP. BLUMENTHAL of the 147th Dist., Chairperson of the Committee on the part of the House, that the substitute bill ought to pass.

AN ACT CONCERNING CAMPAIGN FINANCE LAWS, STATUTORILY RECOGNIZED INDIGENOUS TRIBES AND SECURITY FOR CANDIDATES, THEIR FAMILIES AND THEIR CAMPAIGN STAFFS.

Be it enacted by the Senate and House of Representatives in General Assembly convened:

Section 1. Subsection (f) of section 9-612 of the general statutes is repealed and the following is substituted in lieu thereof (*Effective October 1, 2026*):

(f) (1) As used in this subsection and subsections (g) and (h) of this section:

(A) "Quasi-public agency" has the same meaning as provided in section 1-120.

(B) "State agency" means any office, department, board, council, commission, institution or other agency in the executive or legislative branch of state government.

(C) "State contract" means an agreement or contract with the state or any state agency or any quasi-public agency, let through a procurement process or otherwise, having a value of fifty thousand dollars or more, or a combination or series of such agreements or contracts having a value of one hundred thousand dollars or more in a calendar year, for (i) the rendition of services, (ii) the furnishing of any goods, material, supplies, equipment or any items of any kind, (iii) the construction, alteration or repair of any public building or public work, (iv) the acquisition, sale or lease of any land or building, (v) a licensing arrangement, or (vi) a grant, loan or loan guarantee. "State contract" does not include any agreement or contract with the state, any state agency or any quasi-public agency that is exclusively federally funded, an education loan, a loan to an individual for other than commercial purposes or any agreement or contract between the state or any state agency and the United States Department of the Navy or the United States Department of Defense.

(D) "State contractor" means a person, business entity or nonprofit organization that enters into a state contract. Such person, business entity or nonprofit organization shall be deemed to be a state contractor until December thirty-first of the year in which such contract terminates. "State contractor" does not include a municipality, [or] any other political subdivision of the state or any indigenous tribe of the state recognized under subsection (b) of section 47-59a, including any entities or associations duly created by the municipality, [or] political subdivision or indigenous tribe exclusively amongst themselves to further any purpose authorized by statute, [or] charter or tribal law, or an employee in the executive or legislative branch of state government or a quasi-public agency, whether in the classified or unclassified service and full or part-time, and only in such person's capacity as a state or quasi-public agency employee.

(E) "Prospective state contractor" means a person, business entity or nonprofit organization that (i) submits a response to a state contract solicitation by the state, a state agency or a quasi-public agency, or a proposal in response to a request for proposals by the state, a state agency or a quasi-public agency, until the contract has been entered into, or (ii) holds a valid prequalification certificate issued by the Commissioner of Administrative Services under section 4a-100. "Prospective state contractor" does not include a municipality, [or] any other political subdivision of the state or any indigenous tribe of the state recognized under subsection (b) of section 47-59a, including any entities or associations duly created by the municipality, [or] political subdivision or indigenous tribe exclusively amongst themselves to further any purpose authorized by statute, [or] charter or tribal law, or an employee in the executive or legislative branch of state government or a quasi-public agency, whether in the classified or unclassified service and full or part-time, and only in such person's capacity as a state or quasi-public agency employee.

(F) "Principal of a state contractor or prospective state contractor" means (i) any individual who is a member of the board of directors of, or has an ownership interest of five per cent or more in, a state contractor or prospective state contractor, which is a business entity, except for an individual who is a member of the board of directors of a nonprofit organization, (ii) an individual who is employed by a state contractor or prospective state contractor, which is a business entity, as president, treasurer or executive vice president, (iii) an individual who is the chief executive officer of a state contractor or prospective state contractor, which is not a business entity, or if a state contractor or prospective state contractor has no such officer, then the officer who duly possesses comparable powers and duties, (iv) an officer or an employee of any state contractor or prospective state contractor who has managerial or discretionary responsibilities with respect to a state contract, (v) the spouse or a dependent child who is eighteen years of age or older of an individual described in this subparagraph, or (vi) a political committee established or controlled by an individual described in this subparagraph or the business entity or nonprofit organization that is the state contractor or prospective state contractor.

(G) "Dependent child" means a child residing in an individual's household who may legally be claimed as a dependent on the federal income tax return of such individual.

(H) "Managerial or discretionary responsibilities with respect to a state contract" means having direct, extensive and substantive responsibilities with respect to the negotiation of the state contract and not peripheral, clerical or ministerial responsibilities.

(I) "Rendition of services" means the provision of any service to a state agency or quasi-public agency in exchange for a fee, remuneration or compensation of any kind from the state or through an arrangement with the state.

(J) "State contract solicitation" means a request by a state agency or quasi-public agency, in whatever form issued, including, but not limited to, an invitation to bid, request for proposals, request for information or request for quotes, inviting bids, quotes or other types of submittals, through a competitive procurement process or another process authorized by law waiving competitive procurement.

(K) "Subcontractor" means any person, business entity or nonprofit organization that contracts to perform part or all of the obligations of a state contractor's state contract. Such person, business entity or nonprofit organization shall be deemed to be a subcontractor until December thirty-first of the year in which the subcontract terminates. "Subcontractor" does not include (i) a municipality, [or] any other political subdivision of the state or any indigenous tribe of the state recognized under subsection (b) of section 47-59a, including any entities or associations duly created by the municipality, [or] political subdivision or indigenous tribe exclusively amongst themselves to further any purpose authorized by statute, [or] charter or tribal law, or (ii) an employee in the executive or legislative branch of state government or a quasi-public agency, whether in the classified or unclassified service and full or part-time, and only in such person's capacity as a state or quasi-public agency employee.

(L) "Principal of a subcontractor" means (i) any individual who is a member of the board of directors of, or has an ownership interest of five per cent or more in, a subcontractor, which is a business entity, except for an individual who is a member of the board of directors of a nonprofit organization, (ii) an individual who is employed by a subcontractor, which is a business entity, as president, treasurer or executive vice president, (iii) an individual who is the chief executive officer of a subcontractor, which is not a business entity, or if a subcontractor has no such officer, then the officer who duly possesses comparable powers and duties, (iv) an officer or an employee of any subcontractor who has managerial or discretionary responsibilities with respect to a subcontract with a state contractor, (v) the spouse or a dependent child who is eighteen years of age or older of an individual described in this subparagraph, or (vi) a political committee established or controlled by an individual described in this subparagraph or the business entity or nonprofit organization that is the subcontractor.

(2) (A) No state contractor, prospective state contractor, principal of a state contractor or principal of a prospective state contractor, with regard to a state contract or a state contract solicitation with or from a state agency in the executive branch or a quasi-public agency or a holder, or principal of a holder, of a valid prequalification certificate, shall make a contribution to, or, on and after January 1, 2011, knowingly solicit contributions from the state contractor's or prospective state contractor's employees or from a subcontractor or principals of the subcontractor on behalf of (i) an exploratory committee or candidate committee established by a candidate for nomination or election to the office of Governor, Lieutenant Governor, Attorney General, State Comptroller, Secretary of the State or State Treasurer, (ii) a political committee authorized to make contributions or expenditures to or for the benefit of such candidates, or (iii) a party committee;

(B) No state contractor, prospective state contractor, principal of a state contractor or principal of a prospective state contractor, with regard to a state contract or a state contract solicitation with or from the General Assembly or a holder, or principal of a holder, of a valid prequalification certificate, shall make a contribution to, or, on and after January 1, 2011, knowingly solicit contributions from the state contractor's or prospective state contractor's employees or from a subcontractor or principals of the subcontractor on behalf of (i) an exploratory committee or candidate committee established by a candidate for nomination or election to the office of state senator or state representative, (ii) a political committee authorized to make contributions or expenditures to or for the benefit of such candidates, or (iii) a party committee;

(C) If a state contractor or principal of a state contractor makes or solicits a contribution as prohibited under subparagraph (A) or (B) of this subdivision, as determined by the State Elections Enforcement Commission, the contracting state agency or quasi-public agency may, in the case of a state contract executed on or after February 8, 2007, void the existing contract with such contractor, and no state agency or quasi-public agency shall award the state contractor a state contract or an extension or an amendment to a state contract for one year after the election for which such contribution is made or solicited unless the commission determines that mitigating circumstances exist concerning such violation. No violation of the prohibitions contained in subparagraph (A) or (B) of this subdivision shall be deemed to have occurred if, and only if, the improper contribution is returned to the principal by the later of thirty days after receipt of such contribution by the recipient committee treasurer or the filing date that corresponds with the reporting period in which such contribution was made;

(D) If a prospective state contractor or principal of a prospective state contractor makes or solicits a contribution as prohibited under subparagraph (A) or (B) of this subdivision, as determined by the State Elections Enforcement Commission, no state agency or quasi-public agency shall award the prospective state contractor the contract described in the state contract solicitation or any other state contract for one year after the election for which such contribution is made or solicited unless the commission determines that mitigating circumstances exist concerning such violation. The Commissioner of Administrative Services shall notify applicants of the provisions of this subparagraph and subparagraphs (A) and (B) of this subdivision during the prequalification application process;

(E) The State Elections Enforcement Commission shall make available to each state agency and quasi-public agency a written notice advising state contractors and prospective state contractors of the contribution and solicitation prohibitions contained in subparagraphs (A) and (B) of this subdivision. Such notice shall: (i) Direct each state contractor and prospective state contractor to inform each individual described in subparagraph (F) of subdivision (1) of this subsection, with regard to such state contractor or prospective state contractor, about the provisions of subparagraph (A) or (B) of this subdivision, whichever is applicable, and this subparagraph; (ii) inform each state contractor and prospective state contractor of the civil and criminal penalties that could be imposed for violations of such prohibitions if any such contribution is made or solicited; (iii) inform each state contractor and prospective state contractor that, in the case of a state contractor, if any such contribution is made or solicited, the contract may be voided; (iv) inform each state contractor and prospective state contractor that, in the case of a prospective state contractor, if any such contribution is made or solicited, the contract described in the state contract solicitation shall not be awarded, unless the commission determines that mitigating circumstances exist concerning such violation; and (v) inform each state contractor and prospective state contractor that the state will not award any other state contract to anyone found in violation of such prohibitions for a period of one year after the election for which such contribution is made or solicited, unless the commission determines that mitigating circumstances exist concerning such violation. Each state agency and quasi-public agency shall include in the bid specifications or request for proposals for a state contract, a copy of or Internet link to such notice. No state agency or quasi-public agency shall execute a state contract unless such contract contains a representation that the chief executive officer or authorized signatory of the contract has received such notice; and

(F) (i) Any principal of the state contractor or prospective state contractor submitting a bid or proposal for a state contract shall certify that neither the contractor or prospective state contractor, nor any of its principals, have made any contributions to, or solicited any contributions on behalf of, any party committee, exploratory committee, candidate for state-wide office or for the General Assembly, or political committee authorized to make contributions to or expenditures to or for, the benefit of such candidates, in the previous four years, that were determined by the State Elections Enforcement Commission to be in violation of subparagraph (A) or (B) of this subdivision, without mitigating circumstances having been found to exist concerning such violation. Each such certification shall be sworn as true to the best knowledge and belief of the person signing the certification, subject to the penalties of false statement. If there is any change in the information contained in the most recently filed certification, such person shall submit an updated certification not later than thirty days after the effective date of any such change or upon the submittal of any new bid or proposal for a state contract, whichever is earlier.

(ii) Each state agency and quasi-public agency shall include in the bid specifications or request for proposals for a state contract a notice of the certification requirements of this subparagraph. No state agency or quasi-public agency shall execute a state contract unless the state agency or quasi-public agency obtains the written certification described in this subparagraph.

(iii) Any principal of the state contractor or prospective state contractor submitting a bid or proposal for a state contract shall disclose on the certification all contributions made by any of its principals to any party committee, exploratory committee, candidate for state-wide office or for the General Assembly, or political committee authorized to make contributions to or expenditures to or for the benefit of such candidates for a period of four years prior to the signing of the contract or date of the response to the bid, whichever is longer, and certify that all such contributions have been disclosed.

(3) (A) On and after December 31, 2006, neither the Governor, Lieutenant Governor, Attorney General, State Comptroller, Secretary of

the State or State Treasurer, any candidate for any such office nor any agent of any such official or candidate shall knowingly, wilfully or intentionally solicit contributions on behalf of an exploratory committee or candidate committee established by a candidate for nomination or election to any public office, a political committee or a party committee, from a person who he or she knows is prohibited from making contributions, including a principal of a state contractor or prospective state contractor with regard to a state contract solicitation with or from a state agency in the executive branch or a quasi-public agency or a holder of a valid prequalification certificate.

(B) On and after December 31, 2006, neither a member of the General Assembly, any candidate for any such office nor any agent of any such official or candidate shall knowingly, wilfully or intentionally solicit contributions on behalf of an exploratory committee or candidate committee established by a candidate for nomination or election to any public office, a political committee or a party committee, from a person who he or she knows is prohibited from making contributions, including a principal of a state contractor or prospective state contractor with regard to a state contract solicitation with or from the General Assembly or a holder of a valid prequalification certificate.

(4) The provisions of this subsection shall not apply to the campaign of a principal of a state contractor or prospective state contractor or to a principal of a state contractor or prospective state contractor who is an elected public official.

(5) Each state contractor and prospective state contractor shall make reasonable efforts to comply with the provisions of this subsection. If the State Elections Enforcement Commission determines that a state contractor or prospective state contractor has failed to make reasonable efforts to comply with this subsection, the commission may impose civil penalties against such state contractor or prospective state contractor in accordance with subsection (a) of section 9-7b.

Sec. 2. Section 9-601 of the 2026 supplement to the general statutes is amended by adding subdivision (39) as follows (*Effective July 1, 2026*):

(NEW) (39) "Personal security services" means services rendered to a candidate by one or more individuals, other than on-duty law enforcement personnel, for the personal security of such candidate, such candidate's family or such candidate's campaign staff, which services are necessary as a direct result of campaign activity that would not exist but for such candidate's campaign.

Sec. 3. Subsection (e) of section 9-706 of the 2026 supplement to the general statutes is repealed and the following is substituted in lieu thereof (*Effective July 1, 2026*):

(e) (1) The State Elections Enforcement Commission shall (A) adopt regulations, in accordance with the provisions of chapter 54, on permissible expenditures under subsection (g) of section 9-607, as amended by this act, for qualified candidate committees receiving grants from the fund under sections 9-700 to 9-716, inclusive, [and] (B) on or after July 1, 2021, amend such regulations to permit expenditures for child care services, and (C) on or after July 1, 2026, amend such regulations to permit expenditures for personal security services, which regulations so amended pursuant to this subparagraph shall allow payment for the rendering of such services until the certification of the results of the applicable primary or election.

(2) After the amendment of regulations pursuant to [subparagraph (B)] subparagraphs (B) and (C) of subdivision (1) of this subsection, expenditures for child care services and personal security services made by the qualified candidate committee of a participating candidate shall be deemed permissible if such expenditures (A) are, in the aggregate, not more than the amount of qualifying contributions permitted under section 9-704, and (B) comply with all regulations adopted or amended, as applicable, pursuant to subdivision (1) of this subsection.

Sec. 4. Subsection (c) of section 9-710 of the general statutes is repealed and the following is substituted in lieu thereof (*Effective July 1, 2026*):

(c) A candidate who intends to participate in the Citizens' Election

Program may provide personal funds for such candidate's campaign for nomination or election in an amount not exceeding: (1) For a candidate for the office of Governor, twenty thousand dollars; (2) for a candidate for the office of Lieutenant Governor, Attorney General, State Comptroller, State Treasurer or Secretary of the State, ten thousand dollars; (3) for a candidate for the office of state senator, two thousand dollars; or (4) for a candidate for the office of state representative, one thousand dollars. Such personal funds shall not constitute a qualifying contribution under section 9-704. For the purposes of this section, and after the amendment of regulations pursuant to **[**subparagraph (B)**]** subparagraphs (B) and (C) of subdivision (1) of subsection (e) of section 9-706, as amended by this act, expenditures for child care services or personal security services made directly from any such candidate's personal funds and for which such candidate does not seek reimbursement from his or her candidate committee, as provided in subsection (k) of section 9-607, shall not count toward the amounts provided in subdivisions (1) to (4), inclusive, as applicable, of this subsection.

Sec. 5. Subdivision (2) of subsection (g) of section 9-607 of the general statutes is repealed and the following is substituted in lieu thereof (*Effective July 1, 2026*):

(2) Unless otherwise provided by this chapter, any treasurer, in accomplishing the lawful purposes of the committee, may pay the expenses of: (A) Advertising in electronic and print media; (B) any other form of printed advertising or communications including "thank you" advertising after the election; (C) campaign items, including, but not limited to, brochures, leaflets, flyers, invitations, stationery, envelopes, reply cards, return envelopes, campaign business cards, direct mailings, postcards, palm cards, "thank you" notes, sample ballots and other similar items; (D) political banners and billboards; (E) political paraphernalia, which is customarily given or sold to supporters including, but not limited to, campaign buttons, stickers, pins, pencils, pens, matchbooks, balloons, pads, calendars, magnets, key chains, hats, tee shirts, sweatshirts, frisbees, pot holders, jar openers and other

similar items; (F) purchasing office supplies for campaign or political purposes, campaign photographs, raffle or other fund-raising permits required by law, fund-raiser prizes, postage, express mail delivery services, bulk mail permits, and computer supplies and services; (G) banking service charges to maintain campaign and political accounts; (H) subscriptions to newspapers and periodicals which enhance the candidacy of the candidate or party; (I) lease or rental of office space for campaign or political purposes and expenses in connection therewith including, but not limited to, furniture, parking, storage space, utilities and maintenance, provided a party committee or political committee organized for ongoing political activities may purchase such office space; (J) lease or rental of vehicles for campaign use only; (K) lease, rental or use charges of any ordinary and necessary campaign office equipment including, but not limited to, copy machines, telephones, postage meters, facsimile machines, computer hardware, software and printers, provided a party committee or political committee organized for ongoing political activities may purchase office equipment, and provided further that a candidate committee or a political committee, other than a political committee formed for ongoing political activities or an exploratory committee, may purchase computer equipment; (L) compensation for campaign or committee staff, fringe benefits **[**,**]** and payroll taxes, **[**and child care services, provided (i)**]** provided the candidate and any member of his immediate family shall not receive compensation; **[**, and (ii) compensation for child care services is reasonable and customary for the services rendered;**]** (M) travel, meals and lodging expenses of speakers, campaign or committee workers, the candidate and the candidate's spouse for political and campaign purposes; (N) fund raising; (O) reimbursements to candidates and campaign or committee workers made in accordance with the provisions of this section for campaign-related expenses for which a receipt is received by the treasurer; (P) campaign or committee services of attorneys, accountants, consultants or other professional persons for campaign activities, obtaining or contesting ballot status, nomination, or election, and compliance with this chapter; (Q) purchasing campaign finance reports; (R) repaying permissible campaign loans made to the committee that are properly reported and refunding contributions received from an impermissible source or in excess of the limitations set forth in this chapter; (S) conducting polls concerning any political party, issue, candidate or individual; (T) gifts to campaign or committee workers or purchasing flowers or other commemorative items for political purposes not to exceed one hundred dollars to any one recipient in a calendar year or for the campaign, as the case may be; (U) purchasing tickets or advertising from charities, inaugural committees, or other civic organizations if for a political purpose, for any candidate, a candidate's spouse, a member of a candidate's campaign staff, or members of committees; (V) the inauguration of an elected candidate by that candidate's candidate committee; (W) hiring of halls, rooms, music and other entertainment for political meetings and events; (X) reasonable compensation for public speakers hired by the committee; (Y) transporting electors to the polls and other get-out-the-vote activities on election day; **[**and**]** (Z) <u>child care services and personal security services, provided the amount paid for such services is reasonable and customary for the services rendered; and (AA)</u> any other necessary campaign or political expense.

This act shall take effect as follows and shall amend the following sections:		
Section 1	*October 1, 2026*	9-612(f)
Sec. 2	*July 1, 2026*	9-601(39)
Sec. 3	*July 1, 2026*	9-706(e)
Sec. 4	*July 1, 2026*	9-710(c)
Sec. 5	*July 1, 2026*	9-607(g)(2)

Statement of Legislative Commissioners:

In Section 5(2)(Z), "<u>or</u>" was changed to "<u>and</u>" and "<u>the amount for such services</u>" was changed to "<u>the amount paid for such services</u>" for clarity.

GAE *Joint Favorable Subst. -LCO*

The following Fiscal Impact Statement and Bill Analysis are prepared for the benefit of the members of the General Assembly, solely for purposes of information, summarization and explanation and do not represent the intent of the General Assembly or either chamber thereof for any purpose. In general, fiscal impacts are based upon a variety of informational sources, including the analyst's professional knowledge. Whenever applicable, agency data is consulted as part of the analysis, however final products do not necessarily reflect an assessment from any specific department.

OFA Fiscal Note

State Impact: None

Municipal Impact: None

Explanation

The bill expands existing exemptions from certain definitions under state campaign finance law to statutorily recognized indigenous tribes and designates security as an allowable expenditure under the Citizens' Election Program (CEP), resulting in no fiscal impact to the state or municipalities. There is no impact because most CEP grants are fully spent[1].

The Out Years

State Impact: None

Municipal Impact: None

[1] The Citizens' Election Fund received $79,712 in refunds from CEP candidates in 2024.

OLR Bill Analysis

HB 5546

AN ACT CONCERNING CAMPAIGN FINANCE LAWS, STATUTORILY RECOGNIZED INDIGENOUS TRIBES AND SECURITY FOR CANDIDATES, THEIR FAMILIES AND THEIR CAMPAIGN STAFFS.

SUMMARY

The state's campaign finance laws establish permissible expenditures that candidate committees and exploratory committees may make to accomplish their lawful purposes (for example, staff compensation). The law applies broadly to candidates participating in the Citizens' Election Program (CEP), as well as to those who are privately funded and running in a state or municipal election. However, the law also requires the State Elections Enforcement Commission (SEEC) to adopt regulations on permissible expenditures specifically for participating CEP candidates who qualify for a grant.

This bill requires SEEC, on or after July 1, 2026, to amend the CEP regulations on permissible expenditures to allow for personal security services. After the regulations are amended, the bill authorizes participating candidates who qualify for a grant to spend grant funds for personal security services and child care (which the law already allows) until the results of the related election or primary are certified. The bill also allows privately funded candidates to pay for personal security services using campaign funds.

Relatedly, the bill removes a provision that prohibits candidates and their immediate family members from receiving compensation for providing child care services to a candidate's campaign.

The bill also exempts statutorily recognized Indian tribes in the state, as well as any entities or associations created by a tribe and its political

subdivisions under tribal law, from certain definitions under a state campaign finance law (§ 1).

Lastly, the bill makes technical and conforming changes.

EFFECTIVE DATE: July 1, 2026, except the changes to the campaign finance definitions are effective on October 1, 2026.

PERSONAL SECURITY SERVICES

Under the bill, "personal security services" are services rendered to a candidate from individuals, other than on-duty law enforcement, to protect the candidate or the candidate's family members or campaign staff and that are needed as a direct result of campaign activity that would not exist but for the candidate's campaign.

The bill subjects these expenditures to the following conditions and limits:

1. aggregate personal security services expenditures may not exceed the amount of qualifying contributions (QCs) required to qualify for a CEP grant (for example, in 2026, $20,100 for candidates for state senator and $6,700 for candidates for state representative) and

2. any compensation for personal security services must be reasonable and customary for the services rendered.

By law, participating CEP candidates may give their campaign a limited amount of personal funds (for example, $2,000 for a state senator candidate and $1,000 for a state representative candidate). The bill exempts personal security services expenditures made directly from a candidate's personal funds from these limits, as long as the candidate does not seek reimbursement from his or her candidate committee. The exemption applies once SEEC amends the CEP regulations as required by the bill.

CONTRACTOR DEFINITION

The bill exempts statutorily recognized indigenous tribes in the state, as well as any entities or associations created by a tribe and its political subdivisions under tribal law, from being considered a "state contractor," "prospective state contractor," or "subcontractor" under the state campaign finance law that generally (1) prohibits these contractors from making contributions to statewide and legislative candidates for public office and (2) restricts these candidates from knowingly, willfully, or intentionally accepting contributions from these contractors (see BACKGROUND). Existing law also generally exempts (1) municipalities or other political subdivisions of the state, (2) executive or legislative branch employees, and (3) quasi-public employees.

State law statutorily recognizes the Schaghticoke, the Paucatuck Eastern Pequot, the Mashantucket Pequot, the Mohegan, and the Golden Hill Paugussett tribes.

BACKGROUND

Campaign Finance Prohibitions Regarding Contractors

State law generally bans state contractors, prospective state contractors, pre-qualified contractors, subcontractors, and their principals from making contributions to or on behalf of the following recipients: (1) exploratory or candidate committees for statewide or legislative candidates, (2) political committees authorized to make contributions to or spend on behalf of candidates for statewide or legislative office, or (3) party committees.

It also prohibits contractors from soliciting contributions for these committees from their employees, subcontractors, or subcontractors' principals. The prohibitions are branch-specific (for example, a state contractor contracted with the General Assembly may not engage in these prohibited activities for legislative contests).

Relatedly, constitutional officers, legislators, candidates for these offices, and their agents generally may not knowingly, willfully, or intentionally solicit contributions from a prohibited entity for any exploratory, candidate, political, or party committee.

Related Bill

SB 492, reported favorably by the Government Administration and Elections Committee, among other things, contains identical provisions about allowable personal security expenditures.

COMMITTEE ACTION

Government Administration and Elections Committee

Joint Favorable
Yea 15 Nay 3 (03/20/2026)